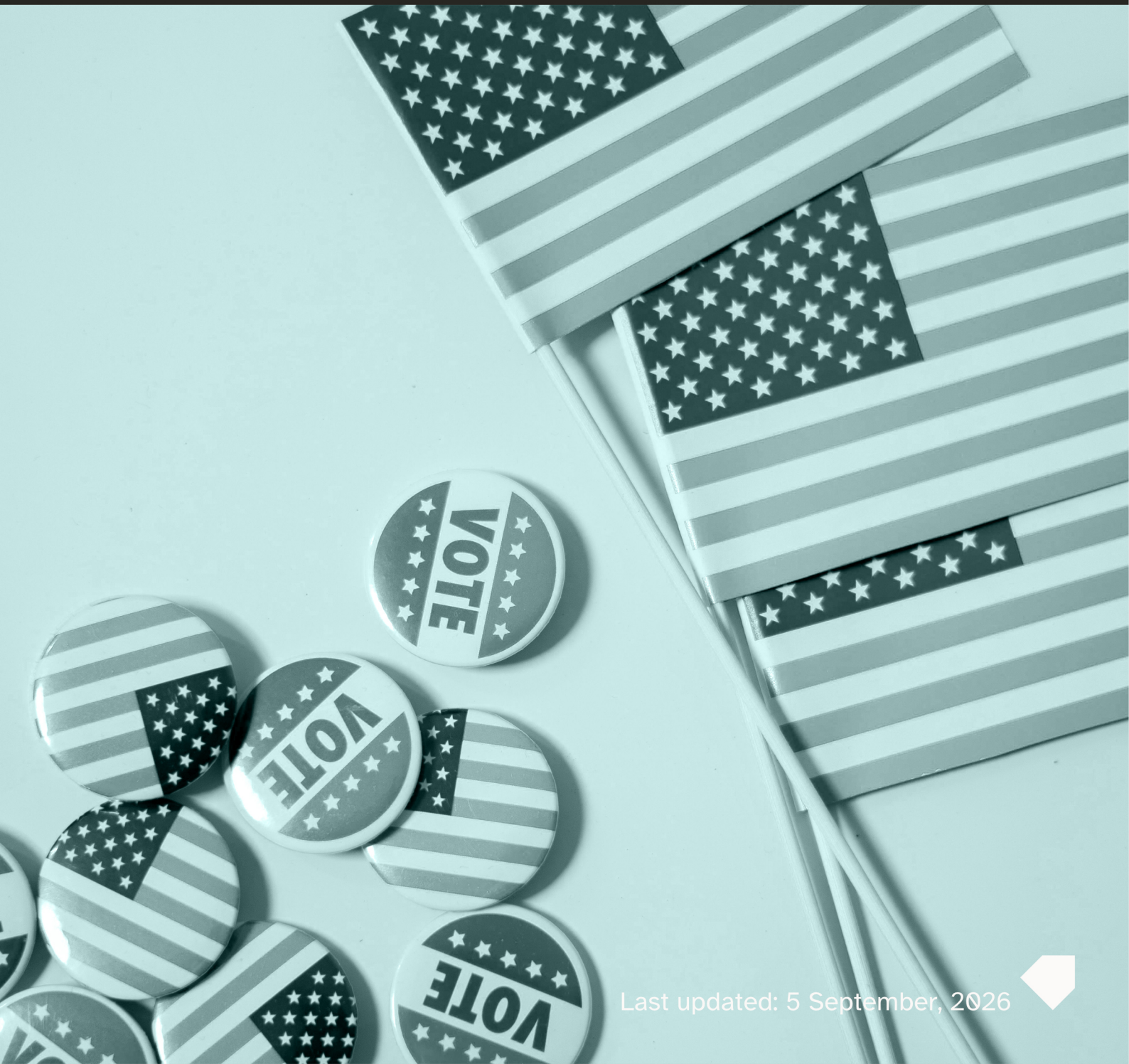




HELP ME VOTE 2026

2026 U.S. Midterm Elections Guide



Last updated: 5 September, 2026



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AN IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

Help Me Leave is a volunteer-run organization and is not a licensed immigration or elections advisory service. This guide is provided free of charge. This guide should be considered general guidance based on information made available by government agencies or reliable international sources at the time this document was last updated and is not considered legal advice.



WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

About the 2026 U.S. midterm elections

The 2026 U.S. midterm general elections are here

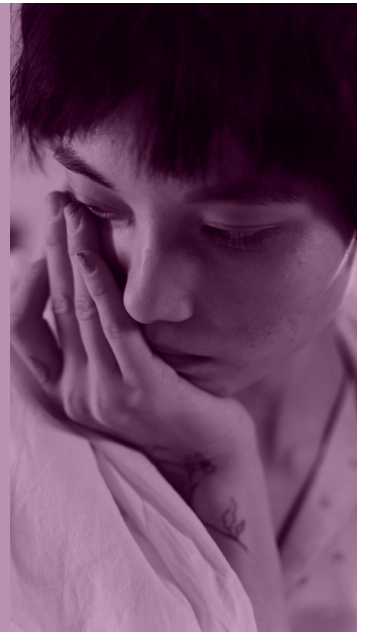
The U.S. midterm elections are here and they are more important than ever for so many people living in fear under the current Trump administration. Already we have seen in the last two years transgender persons lose their legal documentation, disabled persons lose access to necessary care and benefits, and persons of color be detained by immigration enforcement throughout the U.S. What happens in the next two years and possibly beyond will greatly depend on the outcome of these U.S. midterm elections and the representatives that are elected to Congress. These midterm elections are not just "more important than ever" as the news would imply, but in reality these elections are existential to many at-risk Americans living in the U.S. and abroad.

Why are these elections so important to people at-risk in the U.S.?

For most Americans, the cost of gas, the state of the economy, rising unemployment, and the growing crisis with the war in Iran are just some of the concerns most Americans have in these upcoming elections, and each of these reasons are all good reasons to show up to the polls. However, for at-risk persons including those who are transgender, queer, disabled, neurodivergent, persons of color, and foreign-born immigrants, these elections have life-impacting consequences at stake.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO TRANSGENDER, NON-BINARY, AND QUEER PERSONS SO FAR?

- Transgender and non-binary persons already have lost the ability to get an accurate passport with the marker of their accurate gender, or in some states even the ability to get a driver's license or state ID.
- Detained or incarcerated trans women are being put into men's prisons, denied health care, and are subjected to sexual assault, rape, and even death.
- Both trans youth and adults are at risk to losing access to life-saving health care including hormone replacement therapy and gender affirming surgeries.
- Bathroom bans, including a federal bathroom ban in federal public spaces, are being enforced throughout the country, forcing transgender persons either to risk breaking the law or being assaulted when using the bathroom.
- Trans youth are being stripped of access to gender-affirming support from educators or the ability to participate in activities like school sports. This is resulting in an increase of trans youth suicides throughout the country.



WHAT COULD STILL HAPPEN IF THINGS DON'T CHANGE?

- There are plans to designate transgender persons and supportive allies like educators as "sexual offenders" and be subjected to arrest and prosecution.
- Gender affirming health care for trans and non-binary persons could be completely stripped away and made illegal for both youth and adults.
- Some states seek to administer dangerous "conversion therapy" to transgender youth.
- Federal government will continue to pressure hospitals, health care systems, insurance companies, and doctors to stop gender affirming care and instead require them to run "detransition clinics".
- Some states, like Texas, still seek to legalize prosecuting supporting parents of trans youth as child abusers and put the children into state-controlled foster care.
- Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual, and other queer persons may even lose marital rights as far-right wing groups seek to overturn the Supreme Court ruling, Obergefell v. Hodges.



WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO DISABLED AND NEURODIVERGENT PERSONS SO FAR?

- The "One Big Beautiful Bill" is going to result in roughly \$1 trillion in cuts to Medicaid over the next decade and will strip disabled people of access to essential support, resulting in disabled people unable to get medication, be forced to work as much as 80 hours a month, or lose benefits altogether.
- The Social Security Administration has had an approximate 14% staffing cut resulting in severe delays for disabled and elderly persons from getting needed support.
- The Trump administration's department of Justice notified states they were permitted to stop community-based supports and instead institutionalize disabled or neurodivergent people instead.

WHAT COULD STILL HAPPEN IF THINGS DON'T CHANGE?

- Social Security Administration under Trump is looking to cut benefits for disabled persons living under care with family.
- The Trump administration is seeking to make the largest Social Security disability income cut in history and severely limit who can qualify for disability benefits.
- Cuts in the budget Department of Justice Civil Rights division and the Department of Education OCR could effectively make the American with Disabilities Act and other laws unenforceable.
- Institutionalizing disabled or neurodivergent persons could become standing policy.



WHAT HAS HAPPENED TO PERSONS OF COLOR, IMMIGRANTS, AND NATURALIZED CITIZENS SO FAR?

- Through the "One Big Beautiful Bill", Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) is now the highest-funded law enforcement agency in the U.S with a budget of over \$170 billion dollars with additional funding through 2029.
- ICE has terrorized cities like Los Angeles, Chicago, and Minneapolis with headline-grabbing enforcement raids that has resulted in over 340,000 deported in 2025 and thousands more in 2026, despite nearly 75% of detainees having no criminal record.
- After the 2025 June Supreme Court ruling, thousands of deported persons are being sent to third countries they've never been to and are often incarcerated.
- 4 U.S. citizens killed during confrontations with ICE agents
- At least five US citizens, mostly children, have been deported from the U.S.
- The Trump Administration is now aiming to denaturalize up to 200 citizens a month.
- Over 4,400 times have courts ruled that ICE have detained and jailed people illegally without due process.
- Tens of thousands of detainees with final deportation orders are being hidden by ICE.
- Policy changes to remove DEI from federal government and policies resulting in increased unemployment for people of color, access to housing.

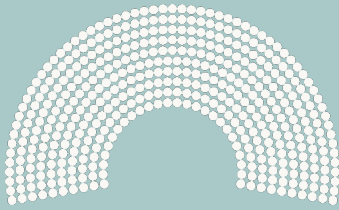


WHAT COULD STILL HAPPEN IF THINGS DON'T CHANGE?

- ICE will continue to receive budget increase and resources resulting in further unrestrained raids often targeting blue states and cities for non-compliance, likely resulting in further violence and tensions throughout the country.
- Denaturalization could become a political tool targeting activists, dissidents, and regime critics.
- Trump will continue to push to pass the "SAVE America Act" to heavily restrict voting access for Americans which would impact fair access to voting for persons of color.

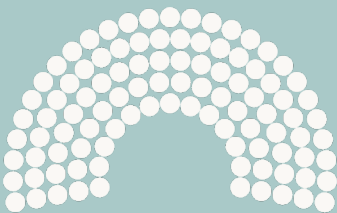
The basics of the U.S. Elections

Elections for city, county, and state government, representation, and proposed laws take place every year. However, the two most notable elections are the presidential elections and the midterm elections. These elections also elect everyone's federal representatives. During both of these elections, all 435 seats in the U.S. House of Representatives are up for election, along with about 33–34 seats in the U.S. Senate. During the presidential election, citizens also vote for the President, who is elected through electoral votes based on the total number of House and Senate seats (plus 3 electoral votes for the District of Columbia). The distribution of House seats — and, effectively, each state's number of electoral votes — is determined by population figures from each Census, taken every ten years.



U.S. HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

- Total number of seats up for election this year: **All 435**
- Seats are distributed based on population.
- Every state has at least one representative.
- U.S. Territories and the District of Columbia have no representation.
- Length of term for each representative: **2 years**



U.S. SENATE

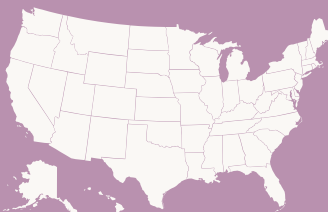
- Total number of seats up for election this year: **35***
*Total seats up for election includes special elections
- 2 seats are assigned to each state.
- U.S. Territories and the District of Columbia have no representation.
- Length of term for each representative: **6 years**



U.S. PRESIDENT

- Current U.S. President: Donald J. Trump (R)
- Up for election this year: **No**
- Elected based on electoral votes each state's popular vote.*
*Except for Maine and Nebraska which their electoral votes are divided among congressional districts.
- U.S. Territories don't vote for the president, but DC does
- Length of term: **4 years, capped at 2 terms**

In addition, to federal representatives, it is also important to pay attention to state governor and legislature races as well. While typically these offices handle state level law and administration, they do confirm and draw the new district maps after a census. Governors also temporarily appoint U.S. Senators for seats that are vacated for any reason until an election for that seat can be held and the state legislature also ratify amendments to the U.S. constitution.



STATE GOVERNORS

- States that have governor races up for election: **36**
- There are 18 seats with no incumbent making this year highly competitive for state level control.
- Elected based on popular vote.
- Length of term for each representative: **4 years***
*Except for Maine and Nebraska which their electoral votes are divided among congressional districts.



STATE LEGISLATORS & SENATORS

- State Legislators are typically up for election every 2 years.
- State Senators are typically up for election every 4 years.*
*Except for Nebraska which has no state senate.
- Elected based on popular vote.
- Length of term for each representative: **4 years***

PLAN YOUR VOTE

Preparing documentation and registering

Preparing your documentation

Voting and registration documentation requirements vary substantially by state. Some states require identification or documentary proof for certain registration or voting situations, while others do not. So be sure to check your state's individualized guide for details. Typically though you only usually need a valid photo ID, some proof of state residency, and a personal identifier like your social security number.

If your state requires photo ID to register or vote you typically can use:

- Valid or expired, undamaged U.S. passport book or passport card
- Enhanced driver's license with photo
- Fully valid state driver's license with photo
- Fully valid state identification with photo
- U.S. military or military dependent ID with photo
- Enhanced Tribal Cards and Native American tribal photo IDs
- State issued voter ID card with photo

Other documentation you may need for certain states:

- Birth certificate or passport to show proof of citizenship
- Social Security Card
- Proof of residency such as a recent utility bill that shows your current address

Examples of valid photo IDs



TRANSGENDER GUIDANCE

If you have completed a legal name change, you must make sure your photo ID is updated to your new legal name. However, your gender marker should not be a factor when proving your identity to register or vote.



Registering to vote

With the exception of North Dakota, every state requires you to register to vote prior to the elections. Some states may allow you to register on the same day that you vote. Some states may allow you to register online in places that already confirm your identity such as your state DMV website. The deadline to register will vary state to state so it's important to check your state's individual guide for details.

States start closing registrations as early as Monday, October 5!

When you register you do the following:

- Provide the required documentation and identification
- Testifying that you are eligible to vote under penalty of perjury
- Providing your signature so they can confirm you when you vote

After you register, you typically stay registered if you consistently vote, however you should always confirm that you are still registered before the deadline to register. Most states allow you to confirm that you are registered to vote through online portals like vote.gov.

THE ATTACK ON MAIL-IN VOTING

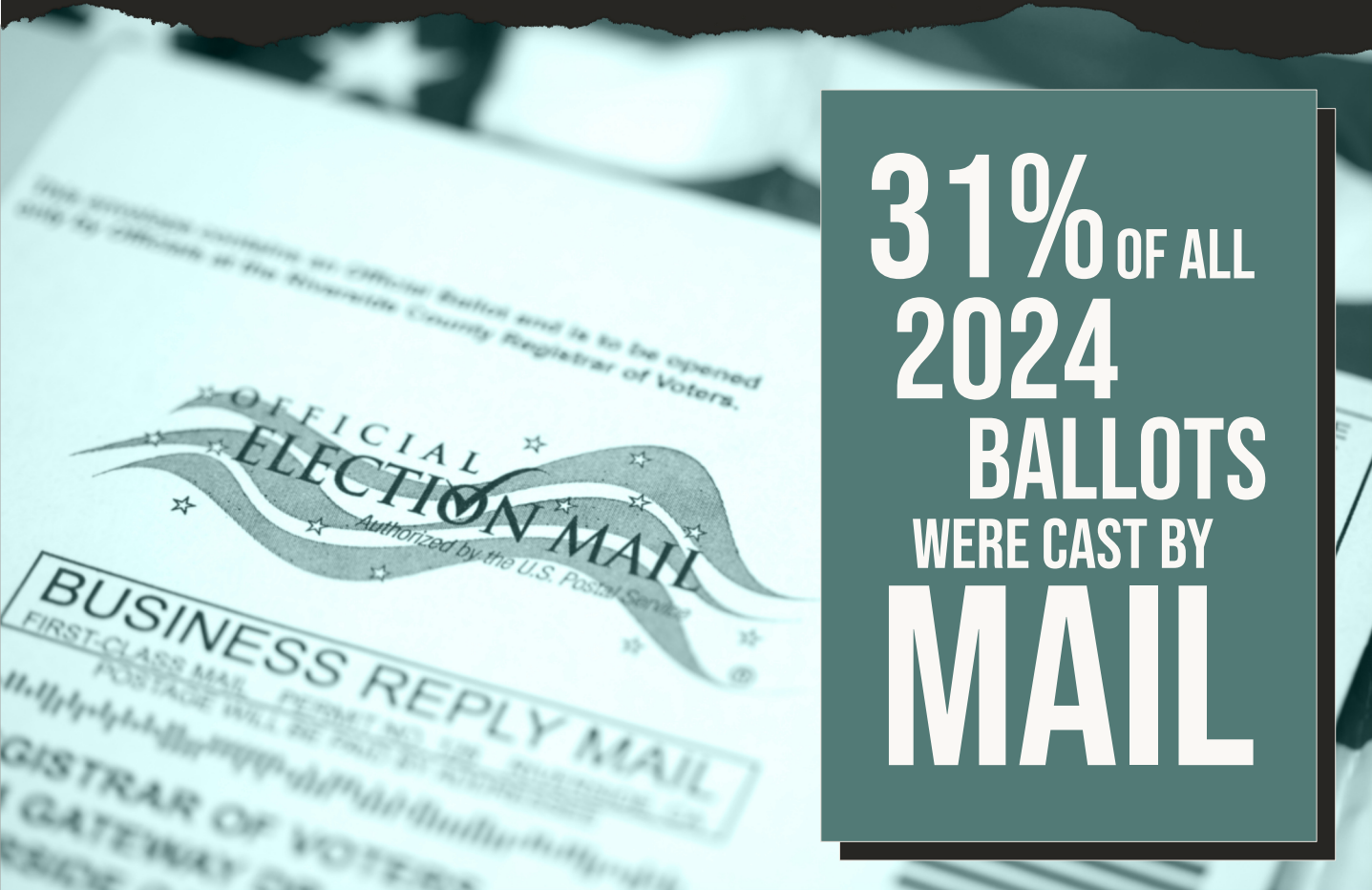
Trump's biggest attack on democracy

It has been no secret that Trump and the Republican party has been attacking the validity of mail-in voting for years now, however in 2026 there have been several attempts to restrict and regulate the practice of voting through the use of mail-in ballots, including in states where mail-in ballots is the primary way to administer the elections.

Those who oppose mail-in voting claim that it cannot be confirmed who is actually voting on the ballot, however mail-in balloting is often seen to be just as secure as voting in person. In reality, the effort to attack mail-in ballots is to heavily discourage those who vote for liberal candidates including those in the Democratic party. A voter typically still needs to verify some form of ID when requesting a ballot or registering to vote, and their signature on the ballot is matched to their signature on their registration. Only a handful of

mail-in ballots over the last several years have been suspected of fraud, and most were either cured by the election office according to state rules, or were disqualified.

This year Trump has attempted to pass the SAVE America Act, a harmful bi-partisan legislation aimed at enforcing strict proof of citizenship rules and regulations to mail-in ballots. Through an executive order, he also attempted to force the United States Postal Service to work with the Department of Homeland Security to require states to report their voter rolls and implement a process to validate voter ballots according to federal databases. Thankfully, as of September 14, the United States Supreme Court has fully blocked that executive order and the USPS published rule for mail-in ballots from going into effect these midterms and is unlikely to succeed overall.



**31% OF ALL
2024
BALLOTS
WERE CAST BY
MAIL**

PLAN YOUR VOTE

Mail, early polls, or on election day

Deciding to vote by mail, early vote, or on election day

Every state has different rules for mail-in/absentee voting, early voting, or voting on election day. It is important to check the specific rules for your state to determine which method is the safest and most reliable for you.



MAIL-IN BALLOT

Despite recent attacks by the Trump administration, voting by mail continues to be one of the most common and secure ways to vote and for most voters abroad, the only way.

- Mail in ballots are paper based and the ballot itself cannot be subjected to possible computer interference unlike voting machines.
- There is a literal paper trail to confirm your ballot arrives and is counted.
- Most states offer online ballot tracking, so you can confirm your ballot was mailed, received, and accepted for counting.
- Some states handle their elections primarily by mail so registered voters are sent a ballot to their mailbox automatically.

Disadvantages:

- Mail in ballots can be rejected by the election office if there are issues like a mismatched signature. So it's important to vote early and confirm your ballot is accepted with time to spare in case any corrections need to be made.
- Some states require a valid excuse or reason to vote by absentee mail-in ballot, making it burdensome to access.



EARLY IN-PERSON

For some states, voting by mail can be burdensome or even not available to most voters, however 47 states plus DC offer early in-person voting at limited locations.

- Early voting in-person allows you to cast your ballot at the election office or at select polling locations before election day which allows greater convenience to your schedule.
- For some states, you can vote at any polling location unlike on election day.

Disadvantages:

- Early voting can be difficult to access depending where you live and may require you to travel farther than your election day polling location.
- Early voting often have limited polling hours for your location.
- Alabama, Mississippi, and New Hampshire all do not offer early in-person voting. They also have very strict excuse requirements for voting absentee by mail.
- Ballot marking devices (i.e. voting machines) are subject to malfunction or manipulation (albeit highly unlikely) when printing your finalized ballot. You have the right to inspect your finalized ballot, void it if there are problems, or request a paper to fill out manually.



ELECTION DAY

For many persons still in America, voting in-person on election day can sometimes be the only choice. It is also the last chance to ensure you can vote if something goes wrong when voting by mail.

- Polling locations are the most available on election day.
- If there are discrepancies to your voter registration or you can't confirm your mail-in ballot arrived, you are entitled to a provisional ballot to be counted if your original ballot is lost.

Disadvantages:

- Lines can be long especially during the opening or closing hours of the polls when most people are either going to or from work on Tuesday.
- Because nearly all in-person voting happens on Election Day, the risk of illegal intimidation is concentrated on that day.
- Because Election Day voting is constrained to one Tuesday with fixed hours, most voters find mail or early voting more convenient.
- Ballot marking devices (i.e. voting machines) are subject to malfunction or manipulation (albeit highly unlikely) when printing your finalized ballot. You have the right to inspect your finalized ballot, void it if there are problems, or request a paper to fill out manually.

ABOUT "ALL MAIL IN-VOTING STATES"

- In mostly mail elections, all active registered voters are sent a ballot in the mail. The voter marks the ballot, puts it in a secrecy envelope or sleeve and then into a separate mailing envelope, signs an affidavit on the exterior of the mailing envelope, and returns the package via mail or by dropping it off.
- Ballots are mailed out well ahead of Election Day, so voters have an "election period," not just a single day, to vote. Mostly mail elections can be thought of as absentee voting for everyone. This system is also referred to as "vote by mail."
- Eight states and Washington, D.C., allow all elections to be conducted entirely by mail: California, Colorado, Hawaii, Nevada, Oregon, Utah, Vermont and Washington state.
- Many of these states still allow voters to register and vote in-person at designated election centers or offices including early voting and registering on the day of the elections.
- Those living abroad who were last registered in these states must still request an overseas ballot be sent to them for them to fill out.

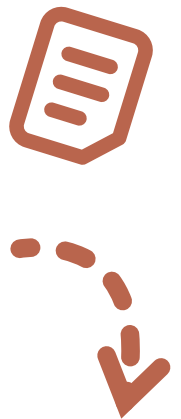


How to vote when you are abroad

Voting abroad can feel complicated but in reality the steps are straight forward. However it takes time and planning to make sure your ballot arrives in time for the midterm elections.

1 REGISTER AND REQUEST YOUR BALLOT

- To register to vote abroad and request your ballot you first need to fill out the **Federal Post Card Application form (FPCA)**. There are online portals like at usvotersabroad.org and democratsabroad.org which can help you automatically fill out the form and know where to send it to.
- **IMPORTANT!** You must print out the form and sign it in ink. **A digital signature will not be accepted.**
- Depending on your state you can either email a photo of the signed form and send it in instantly to your elections office, or you may have to mail it in. **If you have to mail it in, you should get this step done as soon as possible.**



2 RECEIVE AND USE YOUR BALLOT

- Your overseas absentee ballot should arrive either by email to download from a secure website or to your residence mail abroad based on the information you provided in your FPCA form. This varies state to state.
- You must print out the ballot and fill it out in ink and sign it in ink. **A digitally created signature will not be accepted.** Complete your ballot and vote for your candidates.

3 SEND IN YOUR BALLOT

- Follow the instructions from your election office and mail in your ballot. If you live in California, Florida, Louisiana, or Oklahoma, you can actually fax in your ballot for instant delivery to your election office (just expect heavy long distance charges for the fax)
- Use your state's online ballot portal to track your ballot to ensure it arrives on time.
- **If time is short or you don't receive your ballot in a reasonable time frame,** you can fill out the **Federal Write-in Absentee Ballot (FWAB)** form which is a provisional write-in ballot form for all of your elections for your residence.



MAKE YOUR VOTE

Your rights, responsibilities, and deadlines

What are your rights when voting?

When you either vote at home or show up to the polls you are entitled to several rights when voting.



Freedom from intimidation or discrimination.

It is federally criminal to intimidate, threaten, or coerce voters, to discriminate in administering elections, or to lie about the time, place, or manner of an election with intent to keep people from voting. You also have a right to keep your votes confidential from anyone.



You may have a right to language assistance.

If English is not your primary language you may have a right to language assistance depending on where you live including Spanish, Asian, and native American languages when voting. Check your election office for further details.



You have a right to accessibility when voting.

If you have a disability or need help reading, you may bring a person of your choice to assist (with narrow exceptions — not your employer or union agent), and polling places must be accessible.



You may have a right to provisional ballot.

If your name isn't on the roll or your eligibility is disputed, you're entitled to cast a provisional ballot, and you can verify afterward whether it was counted and, if not, why. This law is in most states except for Idaho, Minnesota, New Hampshire, North Dakota, Wisconsin and Wyoming.



You may have a right to take time off to vote.

Over 30 states provide the right to paid or unpaid time off to vote at the polls. Rules can vary state to state so check with your election office or see details in our individual state guide for further detail for your state.



You have a right to vote from abroad even if you never intend to return to the United States.

If you live abroad and remain a U.S. citizen, you are not restricted from voting even if you never intend to return to the United States. However, you must file a new FPCA form every year you vote or whenever you move to a new address abroad.

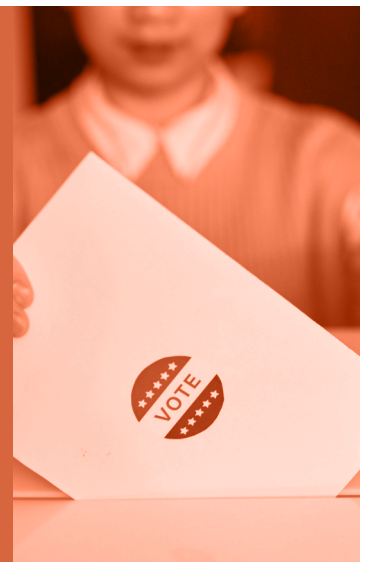


WARNING! You LOSE the right to vote if you renunciate your US citizenship.

If you immigrate abroad and decide to renunciate your US citizenship, you permanently lose your right to vote in any election in the United States. Note. renunciation is a complicated process and you must have citizenship in another country before you are allowed to renunciate your US citizenship.

ABOUT PROVISIONAL BALLOTS

- If you are not found to be on the voter roll at your designated poll location or if there is a complication with an absentee ballot, you have the right to fill out a provisional ballot to ensure that you can vote.
- Your provisional ballot can only count if your original ballot fails to arrive and be processed, and you must resolve any issues within a timely manner with your election office that came up when you attempted to vote that required you to complete a provisional ballot.
- If your provisional ballot is not counted, you have a right to be informed why the ballot was not counted, after which you may be able to pursue legal options to cure your ballot though this is extremely difficult to do so.
- If you are voting abroad you must use the Federal Write-in Absentee Ballot (FWAB) to submit your vote if you fail to receive your official overseas ballot from your election office from your FPCA ballot request.



What are your responsibilities when voting?

When you either vote at home or show up to the polls you are entitled to several rights when voting.



You must check your voter registration to ensure you are still registered to vote.

States purge voter registrations if they have reason to believe you moved or have some other reason that disqualifies you from voting in that election district. You should always check your registration before the registration deadline for each election. For most states, you can check your registration status online typically through your election officials or secretary of state website for your state.



You must report problems you see to a poll worker or an election official.

If you see something that you believe is against the law or is not working right when voting, you must report it to a poll worker or an election official. If it is impacting your ballot, you have a right to spoil that ballot and complete a new one. If there are problems with your ballot from being counted you must work with you election office to cure your ballot in a timely manner.



You must adhere to your state's deadlines.

Every state has different deadlines for registering to vote, requesting an absentee mail-in ballot and returning your ballot on time. See our individual state guide for the specific deadlines in your state.



Don't campaign inside or around the polling place.

Electioneering bans kick in at a state-specified distance from the entrance (usually 25-100 feet). This includes wearing campaign merchandise like T-shirts, hats, and pins at the polling location. If you see this happening, you should report it to a poll worker.



Use of electronic devices are typically prohibited.

Cell phones, tablets, and computers are typically prohibited from being used inside a polling location. You should keep your cell phone silenced and put away as you vote.

What are your deadlines when voting in the U.S.?

There are several deadlines to pay attention to. Some of these are hard deadlines where if you miss them, you will lose the ability to vote or your ballot will not be counted. Some of these are soft deadlines that are recommendations to meet them to ensure your ballot arrives on time and is counted, but missing them doesn't necessarily completely disenfranchise you. These deadlines are specifically for when you are voting while still in the United States.

4
OCTOBER

REGISTER TO VOTE

- Registration deadlines vary state to state but states start closing their registrations as early as 4 October.
- This is also the deadline to make sure your registration is still valid if you have voted in a previous election.

12
OCTOBER

REQUEST YOUR ABSENTEE BALLOT

- For states that only send out an absentee ballot on request, there is typically a specific deadline to do so.
- If you miss this deadline, you will not be able to vote by mail but you can still vote in person through early voting if available or on election day.

27
OCTOBER

MAIL IN YOUR ABSENTEE BALLOT

- A good guideline to ensure your ballot arrives is to make sure you mail out your ballot a full week in advance.
- You may have more time if your state allows additional days to receive ballots that are postmarked by election day, but you should consider returning your ballot as soon as possible.

27-31
OCTOBER

VOTE EARLY IN-PERSON

- If you want to vote early in person, you have a limited calendar based on your state's schedule.
- Notably, Louisiana closes early voting the soonest on 27 October but many states offer early voting right up until the Monday before election day.
- If you don't make it in time to vote early, you have to vote only on election day.

2
NOVEMBER

CONFIRM RECEIPT OF YOUR BALLOT

- If you use mail-in voting use your state's website to track if your ballot arrived.
- If your ballot is not showing to have arrive by the Monday before election day, you may need to arrive at your polling place and request a provisional ballot.

3
NOVEMBER

VOTE IN-PERSON ON ELECTION DAY

- If you don't use mail-in voting or vote early you need to vote on election day.
- Polls typically close either 6:00 PM or 7:00 PM your local time zone and may vary based on where you live in your state.
- If you don't make it in time to vote early, you have to vote only on election day.



*Some states have their registration deadlines set for 4 October on most years, but this year, 4 October falls on a Sunday, therefore the deadline for those states is extended to October 5.

What are your deadlines when voting from abroad?

For those who live abroad the timing for voting is more complicated and you typically need to request your ballot and vote very early to ensure your ballot arrives in time.

**15
SEPTEMBER**

REQUEST YOUR OVERSEAS BALLOT

- The general guideline to request your ballot if you are voting overseas is August 1 if you have to mail in your request.
- If you can electronically submit your request, your timing window is more wide open, but should complete by September 15th.
- Doing this step also registers you to vote.

**26
SEPTEMBER**

CHECK FOR YOUR BALLOT

- If you requested your ballot from abroad, you should frequently check for your ballot to arrive by mail or electronically.
- If you haven't gotten it by September 26, you should consider contacting your election office to ensure it has been sent.

**13
OCTOBER**

MAIL BACK YOUR COMPLETED BALLOT

- You should try to send your completed ballot at least three weeks in advance of election day, so by no later than October 13.
- If you need to mail later you may need to pay extra postage to expedite your ballot to the election office.

**20
OCTOBER**

SEND IN A FWAB BALLOT IF NEEDED

- If you still have not received your overseas ballot from your election office, you should instead send in a Foreign Write-in Absentee Ballot instead.

**27
OCTOBER**

CONFIRM RECEIPT OF YOUR BALLOT

- Follow your state or election office ballot tracking website to confirm receipt of your ballot.
- If your ballot does not arrive by 27 October, you may need to prepare to vote with an FWAB ballot and have it be sent by diplomatic pouch at your local U.S. embassy.
- Note, if in the event both your original absentee ballot and your FWAB ballot arrives, only the first one received is counted.



DID YOU KNOW?
ONLY ABOUT **11% OF ELIGIBLE VOTERS**
LIVING ABROAD ACTUALLY VOTED IN 2024?



DEMOCRACY UNDER SIEGE

Why are nations slipping into autocracy?

In the 2025 report from the V-Dem Institute, a leading democracy watchdog organization, has for the first time reduced the status of the United States from a liberal democracy to an electoral democracy. What does this mean? While electoral democracies continue to have free and fair elections, the checks and balances of executive power and a strong rule of law are compromised.

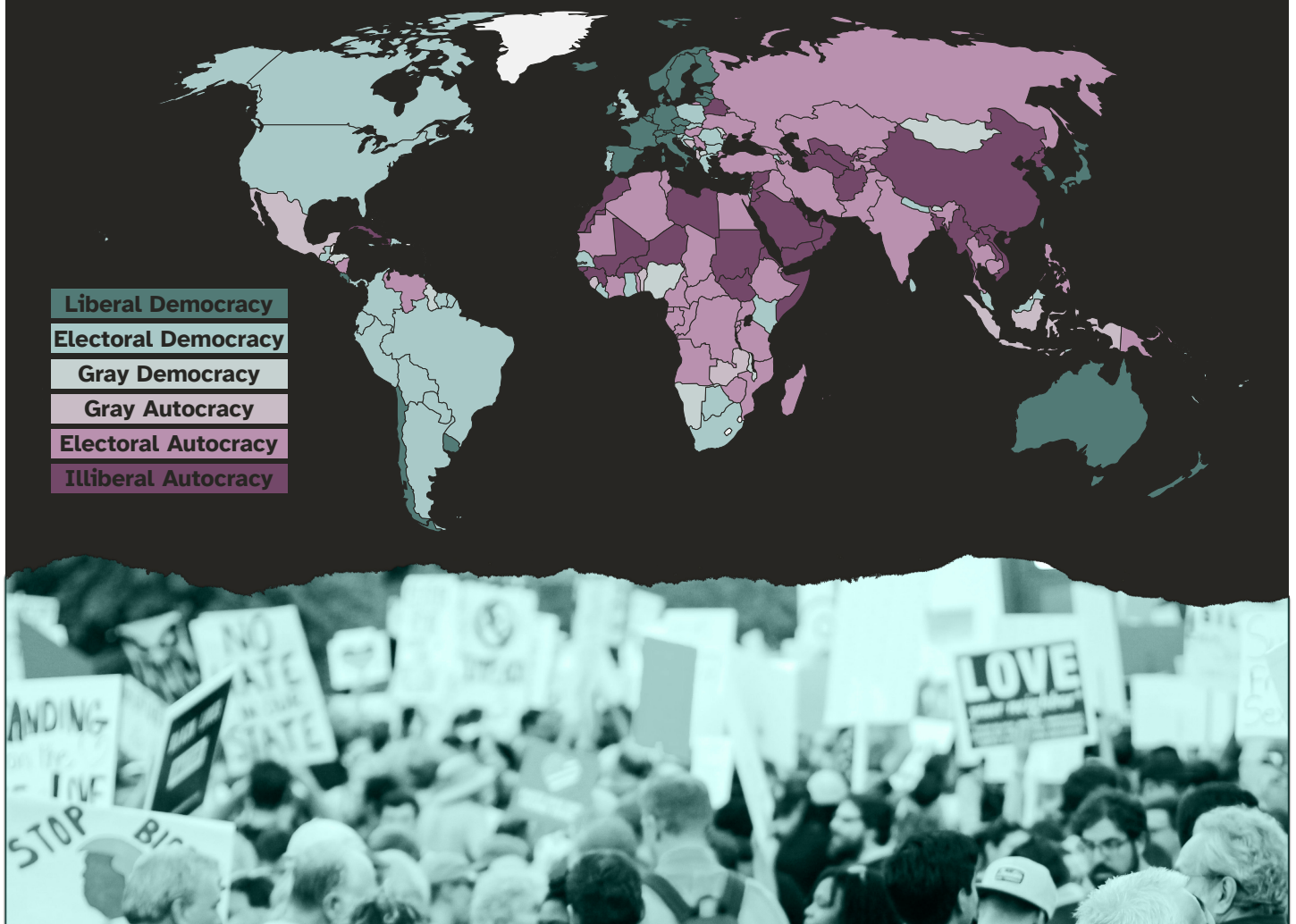
Ever since the 1 July, 2024 Supreme Court ruling on Presidential Immunity, the Trump administration has been able to act almost independently without little to no intervention from Congress or the courts. Trump has also since planted loyalists into key government positions to further cement his hold on executive power in the country.

The United States hasn't been the only nation that has seen democratic backsliding. In fact a total of 44 nations worldwide have been seen to be slipping toward autocracy, 44 nations have shown freedom of expression deteriorating, and 22 nations have had the quality of their

elections be impacted. Nearly three quarters of the world population now lives in a nation that is considered an autocracy in some shape or form, versus just 50% twenty years ago. Today only about 7% of the world's population lives in what is considered liberal democracies.

Autocratization is typically driven by elected incumbents who hollow out independent institutions, courts, media, and oversight bodies, gradually and legally from within, rather than by coups, and the polarization, weak opposition, and diminished public mobilization that enable them are now widespread across both new and long-established democracies. While what we are seeing in the United States is similar to what is happening in a lot of nations around the world, it can be noted that the rate of democratic backsliding in the U.S. is on a scale that has never been before.

You can read the full report at <https://v-dem.net>.



TRACK YOUR VOTE

Making sure your vote counts

How to keep an eye on your ballot throughout the process

Once you send in your vote, keeping track of it is just as equally important as actually making your vote. Thankfully, many states today make it easy to track the status of your ballot, even if you vote at the polls.

1 TRACKING YOUR BALLOT ONLINE

- Most states offer an online voter portal to track the status of your ballot.
- You can look up your state's voter portal typically through the election office or secretary of state website for your state.
- Mail-in ballots are provided tracking through a standardized barcode used by most tracking systems.



2 CURING YOUR BALLOT IF NEEDED

- If there is ever a problem with your ballot, you are often given a reasonable amount of time to "cure" your ballot. Which means correcting any issues that would otherwise invalidate your vote.
- If you are notified by your election office of a problem, it is important to act on it immediately, otherwise you could be disenfranchised for the election.

3 CONFIRMING RESULTS

- On the day of, legacy news agencies will typically rely on reports coming from the state election offices to update you in real-time of the outcome of the election. However results will remain "unofficial" and "projected" until confirmed by the state.
- You can use your state's voter portal to confirm your ballot was counted or you can contact your election office for further assistance if necessary.



WHAT IS TRUMP'S "SAVE AMERICA ACT" AND WHY IS IT DANGEROUS TO AMERICAN DEMOCRACY?

- In early 2026, Trump began pushing Congress to pass an extreme election reform bill called the "Safeguard American Voter Eligibility (SAVE) Act" which proposes federalizing and regulating key components of elections in the United States.
- Under this law, citizens would be required to provide proof of citizenship, something that only certain identifying documents like a passport or birth certificate does. This law would disenfranchise anyone who didn't have those documents or their name differs from the original document (like a married woman's or a transgender person's birth certificate).
- Other provisions would implement mail-in ballot restrictions and voter rolls being reported to the Department of Homeland Security allowing for possible manipulation.
- ***This legislation is currently stalled in the U.S. Senate and is not expected to pass in time to impact the midterms but could become an issue in 2028.***

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER

Understanding the results the midterms

Watching the results of the midterms

Once the polls close on election day, major news networks will likely spend several hours into the night covering the results as they are reported in. As we have seen in many of the elections these last few years it can take a long time to determine the results for some races and we may not know which party will take control of the U.S. House or the U.S. Senate by the time the networks end their broadcasts. If you don't have access to network television in the United States, both ABC and NBC are known to provide live streaming coverage of their elections on YouTube.

There are other factors that can delay the outcome to as late as December. In the states of Mississippi or Georgia, if there is no majority for any candidate (meaning the leading candidate doesn't have at least 50.1% of the vote), then the race goes to a runoff among the two top candidates. In addition, specifically to this year, there was a change in Louisiana to how their primaries work, and so House seat primaries are taking place on November 3 with their general election taking place later in December. So be prepared to not know what happens right away and be patient.

WHY TRUMP WILL TRY TO LIE AND MISLEAD

It's no surprise that President Trump is obsessed with keeping Republican majorities in Congress for the remainder of his term, and in reality he is playing a long game to lock in political power even after 2028. While he is term-limited as president, he has shown extremely worrying signs that he is willing to overthrow constitutional law. In any case, losing either house of Congress will effectively make him lose political control for the remainder of his term, and he will be forced to spend countless days before Congress to account for his recent actions in the first two years of his second term.

As we have seen in 2020, there have been moments where violent rhetoric and deadly violence itself did escalate including the armed protest at the Maricopa county in Arizona and the January 6 insurrection at the U.S. Capitol, and many of these incidents were created through Trump provoking his political base into violent action.

In addition we have seen Trump take several steps of action into investigating the 2020 election including raids on election offices and voting groups in Georgia and Ohio, along with delivering a national address claiming foreign interference on the 2020 elections. Through an attempted and failed executive order, he tried to force the USPS to only deliver mail-in ballots to recognized federal-enrolled lists, and it is now blocked at the Supreme Court for at least the 2026 midterms.

Even though Trump didn't get his restrictions on mail-in voting, he is going to work to create so much doubt between now and election day. There have been reports of a drafted order being proposed to invoke emergency powers to take control of the elections, and that would needlessly create a nightmare scenario in the 2026 midterms that could very well break U.S. democracy. However, this is not adopted or signed.

It is important to remember that despite this terrifying news flooding the headlines, that you take every reasonable step to ensure your vote counts. If you vote by mail, make sure to vote early and confirm your ballot arrives at your election office or county clerk. Use ballot tracking tools online. When voting in person, ensure your ballot is clearly marked. If you have to vote on election day, give yourself plenty of time to vote.

Regardless of what happens, making sure you vote is the single, most-powerful form of action that you can do in this moment to invoke positive change in the outcome of the 2026 midterms.



WHAT HAPPENS AFTER

Understanding the midterms results

Calendar from election day to the first day that Congress begins

There are several key dates from the time election day ends to the time when the new Congress comes into office.

3
NOVEMBER

ELECTION DAY

- Most votes will have been reported in.
- Remaining votes that could come need to be postmarked in order to be counted (depends on each state's rules).



4-10
NOVEMBER

COUNTING CONTINUES

- Precision counts can take several days along with resolving ballots that need to be cured.
- Local canvassing begins.

10-26
NOVEMBER

STATE CANVAS

- States receive the final local counts from their election offices and begin the final tally for votes.
- Certification of the results now begins.

NOVEMBER
THROUGH
DECEMBER

STATE CERTIFICATION

- States submit their final certifications to Congress.
- Any election runoffs are now being prepared.

1
DECEMBER

GEORGIA AND MISSISSIPPI RUNOFFS

- If needed races in these states go to a run off to determine the outcome of each needed race.
- A runoff is required if the leading candidate does not have a majority (50.1%).

12
DECEMBER

LOUISIANA GENERAL ELECTION

- U.S. House races for the state of Louisiana will have their general election.
- We may not know which party will control the U.S. House until this date.

3
JANUARY

120TH CONGRESS BEGINS

- At this point the new Congress will begin.
- Whoever controls both houses of Congress will determine how much power that President Trump will retain for the remaining of his term.



WHAT HAPPENS AFTER

Understanding the midterms results

Election outcomes and how to react as an at-risk American?

There are four main possibilities that could happen after the midterms and while there is a lot of hope that Democrats will at least take one of the two houses of Congress, there is still going to be a lot of hard months ahead for at-risk Americans no matter what. Understanding the main possibilities will help you prepare your next steps on finding safety either in the US or abroad.

DEMOCRATS TAKE ONE OR BOTH HOUSES OF CONGRESS

- While things could change quickly as of the time of this guide's publishing, many polling institutions are highly predicting that the Democrats will most likely take the House and there is a small possibility of them taking the Senate.
- Taking the House effectively stops any harmful legislation that Trump has been trying to push forward from ever advancing, though harmful executive orders continue.
- Taking the Senate also stops Trump from pushing through loyalist picks for his cabinet, key federal offices, or judicial openings.
- Funding for harmful programs or agencies like ICE could dry up.



HOW TO REACT AS AN AT-RISK AMERICAN

- Time is effectively bought for anyone who is at-risk still living in America and would reduce risks to any liberties or rights to what state-level law is passing.
- This doesn't necessarily remove the risk of staying in America or in a state where your rights may be at risk. You may still want to consider your long term future as the 2028 Presidential elections come shortly after.
- Expect Trump to invoke violence and expect protests against his administration, and more be faced with retaliatory violence from federal law enforcement.
- Temper expectations for immediate changes to happen.

DEMOCRATS GET A HIGH MAJORITY IN THE SENATE

- In a highly unlikely scenario, Democrats could get 60 or more seats in the Senate, which would give them effective control over lawmaking, though most would likely be blocked by Trump vetoing any bills coming to his desk.
- With a high majority in the Senate, the possibility of Trump facing a bi-partisan impeachment and conviction becomes very real.
- This would require surprise upsets in dark-red states and such a stunning result would result in protests, legal challenges, and fraud claims from the far-right.



HOW TO REACT AS AN AT-RISK AMERICAN

- In this optimistic scenario, there is reason to potentially pivot or delay any plans of leaving but it's important to keep paying attention to the news as Trump resists the new Congress.
- Again, the risk of staying is not necessarily gone, but it's far more likely to be under better control.
- Some groups like transgender Americans will likely continue to struggle to restore any rights lost including access to accurate documentation and health care that may have been stripped away.

REPUBLICANS RETAIN MAJORITIES IN BOTH HOUSES

- In an unlikely scenario, not even counting for any election interference, Republicans hold onto their majorities in both houses of Congress.
- This would continue the current flow of harmful tactics of the Trump administration, and Trump would continue his documented efforts with attempting to maintain political influence and control indefinitely long after his term is over.
- Transgender, queer, disabled, neurodivergent, immigrants, and people of color would also continue to face dangerous conditions as new laws strip their rights and liberties.



HOW TO REACT AS AN AT-RISK AMERICAN

- In this scenario, things continue as they have been for the past two years but now Trump will be looking to complete as many things as he can before the end of his term and we can expect more executive orders that harm at-risk Americans.
- Any plans to consider getting out should be kept on schedule but you will want to carefully watch to see how the 2028 Presidential elections develop to determine if you need to speed up your timeline or not.
- Be extra careful if you are in a red state, where laws against your rights are now more likely to be pushed through. Consider relocating to a blue state for the short-term.

REPUBLICANS INCREASE MAJORITIES IN BOTH HOUSES

- In an extremely unlikely scenario, Republicans manage to grow their majorities in Congress, including possibly 60 or more seats in the Senate.
- This would be a disastrous scenario for at-risk groups as "Project 2025" initiatives could finally be codified into law, immediately putting at-risk groups in danger.
- It would also very likely create a scenario where American democracy would slip into an electoral autocracy, with Republicans effectively take control of the country as a one-party state.



HOW TO REACT AS AN AT-RISK AMERICAN

- At this point any at-risk American planning immigration would strongly need to consider accelerating plans to leave the country as harmful legislation that would almost certainly be permanent would come into effect within weeks.
- The ability to leave the U.S. may be compromised as federal crackdowns continue.
- Pay attention to news and be extremely careful participating in protests or other free speech activities as we have already seen federal crackdown of those liberties.
- Also stock up on needed supplies including food, dry fuel for heating, medicine, etc.
- Consider documenting any harms you encounter while living in the United States.

IT'S NOT OVER, NO MATTER WHAT HAPPENS

No matter what happens after these Midterms, the fight to preserve American democracy is far from over. Unless he is somehow removed from office, Trump still intends to question and challenge our election systems and find ways to make our democracy less secure as we go into 2028.

So it will be important to stay vigilant to what happens after, and to continue to hold our elected leaders on both sides of the aisle accountable for what happens these next two years. It will not be easy and we can be certain that there will be more unexpected events to come that will impact the lives of everyone.



WHAT IS HELP ME LEAVE?

If you feel you are at risk, you have options

Help Me Leave helps marginalized people find safe and legal pathways to live in other countries while advocating for the human rights of refugees and immigrants from all countries.

What We Do

We help people find safe and legal migration pathways through our information hub and one-on-one support team. And we're building a community of people who support and help one another in finding routes to greater safety.

Our purpose is to provide **practical information, support, and advocacy** to individuals seeking safety and stability outside their country of origin.

- **Information:** We research, collect, and verify credible data about destination countries for potential emigrants, focusing on safety, visa accessibility, and protections for marginalized communities.
- **Support:** We provide peer-to-peer support to those who need to leave urgently or are in imminent danger, as well as a robust online community that fosters information-sharing and solidarity between like-minded individuals.
- **Advocacy:** We advocate for the human rights of refugees and immigrants from all countries through campaigns and partnerships. Through our current #NoLongerSafe campaign, Help Me Leave is advocating for the EU and surrounding nations to remove the U.S. from "safe country of origin" and "safe third country" lists.



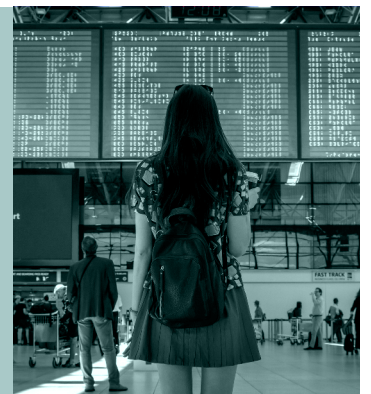
We Are Everyday People

Our international team of volunteers is united by a shared belief that everyone deserves access to accurate, up-to-date information and that informed decisions are safer decisions. Many of us have lived through migration ourselves. We know how overwhelming it can be to navigate complex government systems while facing threats to your rights, safety and survival. This work is grounded in human rights, harm reduction, and informed consent. We never encourage unsafe or illegal routes, nor do we glamorize the difficult immigration process. We aim to meet people where they are and provide tools to help them make informed decisions for themselves and their families.

WE ARE NOT GOING ANYWHERE

The past two years have been unlike anything we could have ever predicted and the pain of seeing so many people hurt by this administration is immeasurable. We know that even in a best case scenario, Trump and his administration will continue to do what they can to put the lives of transgender, queer, disabled, neurodivergent, immigrant, or people of color in harms way.

Help Me Leave is remaining committed to doing what we can to help at-risk Americans discover options to finding safety either within the United States or abroad as long as Trump or any other far-right leader continue to remain in office.



YOU ARE NOT ALONE IN THIS JOURNEY

If you are an at-risk American and you are seeking help to leave the United States during this dangerous time, contact our support team at helpmeleave.us or join our **community discord server** where you can get guidance and advice from those who have immigrated or are on the same journey as you.

THANK YOU FOR VOTING

A message from the Help Me Leave team

Hei hei everyone, my name is Kaedi and I am the head of the Help Me Leave support team and the author of this 2026 Elections guide. This has been an important project for me for the last few weeks, and it took the whole team to get this together, checked and prepared so that we can push it out to as many Americans as we can. Help Me Leave's goal is always been about helping at-risk Americans who are facing a potentially dangerous future. I know, I was one of them. While our primary goal is to find solutions for Americans to find safety living abroad in other countries, we still want to encourage as many people to invoke positive change so that maybe one day America may be safe for everyone again. That is why I made this guide.

A lot has changed in America over the last ten years. For some, they may not notice the changes. For many, the whirlwind of news, violence, and hatred continues to haunt their lives every day, and I promised that I would not stop finding ways to help those who are just as scared as I am of what is happening to my country of birth. I remember the chaos and violence that came in 2020, and I worry those days may happen again unless we put a stop to it now. Voting is the single most powerful form of action every person can do to bring positive change to their government and their home.



Ironically voting as an American feels weird for me now. I worked so hard in 2024 and 2025 to get out and move to Norway and in someways, I feel like I shouldn't have a say to what happens in American now. However, that is far from the truth. I left, because I didn't feel safe in America anymore, and I still see so many who still don't feel safe and that bothers me and that is why I am voting in this election. Voting from abroad was an interesting experience for me as I just mailed off my ballot just a few days before this guide was published, but it felt like I made a final wish for my former home to be a better place, and I think that gives me hope for the future, even if America is now my past.

So please, get out there and vote. Too many people are depending on it. How these midterm elections turn out is very likely going to determine if at-risk Americans have a voice and right to exist for years to come. Your vote matters. Thank you and I hope you find this guide useful.

Kaedi



GLOSSARY

Absentee ballot – A voting ballot that is completed prior to the election and is submitted through mail and/or submitted at a designated location. In Michigan, voters can cast ballots early for any reason.

Ballot – A ballot is used to cast and record votes to be counted on Election Day. A voter can cast their ballot at a polling station or by mail as an absentee.

Ballot box – A secured box that stores marked voter ballots until the end of Election Day.

Campaign – An organized effort that implements several strategies and events in order to gain votes.

Candidate – A person who applies to run for a position and meets the requirements.

Caucus – A conference where political party members select candidates to represent the interests of the party.

Citizen – An individual who is a legal resident and member of the country either through birth or naturalization.

Clerk – A person charged with certain clerical or recording duties and responsibilities.

Closed primary election – This is an election open only to voters registered with a given party to vote in that party's primary election.

Congress – The House of Representatives and the Senate make up Congress. Members of Congress conduct the business of the United States government and initiate laws and policies.

Congressional district – A geographic area in which a citizen is elected to represent residents within that area at the national level in the House of Representatives as their Congressman/Congresswoman.

Conservative – A citizen who identifies with the Republican Party and its philosophies/policies.

Constituency – A specific area in which an elected member of office represents.

Constituent – An individual who emanates from the same geographic area as the elected official who represents them.

Constitution – A set of policies/laws that established the government of the United States of America and its governance. It grants citizens the right to participate in the governance of the country through voting.

Constitutional right – Protections and liberties that are written and guaranteed in the United States Constitution.

Council – A group of people designated or elected to serve in an advisory, administrative, or legislative capacity.

Council member – A member of a council, especially a legislative council.

County commission – A form of local government that functions at the county level.

Delegate – An individual who has been elected to represent a group of people in a political setting.

Democracy – A form of government governed by elected officials that empowers its citizens to exercise political control through voting.

Democrat – A citizen who prescribes to and agrees with the platform and policies of the Democratic Party.

democratic – (lower case) Of or pertaining to democracy.

Democratic – (capitalized) Of or pertaining to the Democratic Party.

District – A geographical area that is divided into smaller areas for the purpose of electoral representation in each area. Look up what Detroit district you reside in here.

Elect – To officially select a decision by voting for a candidate or proposal.

Election – The process of citizens casting their votes to select government officials.

Election committee – A group formed for purposes of monitoring an election.

Election integrity – An open and fair election process.

Electoral – An adjective that is used to describe anything pertaining to an election.

Electoral vote – The Electoral College Act established special electors for presidential elections. Each state has a particular number of presidential electors who are members of the electoral college. The candidate who reaches the majority of the electoral college votes first wins the presidential election.

Electorate – The number of citizens who are legally eligible to vote during any election.

Electors – Citizens who are legally eligible to vote and cast a vote during any election.

Executive order – A function of the president to declare and/or execute certain rules, actions or policies.

Federal – A term that refers to the federal government.

Federal government – A centralized operation formed by individual states in the United States of America (USA) for purposes of governing.

Franchise – The constitutional right to vote in a public election.

General election – The main election period where candidates are voted into offices, following the primary election. This usually takes place in November.

Gerrymandering – A process that manipulates electoral district boundaries to favor one party or candidate over another.

Governor – The elected executive of a U.S. state. Governors initiate new policies, enforce laws, manage budgets, and oversee regulation of courts, and state agencies for the betterment of the residents.

Gubernatorial – Of or pertaining to a state governor or their office.

House of Representatives – There are 435 voting representatives elected from across the country that make up this part of Congress. The number of representatives that each state sends to the house is based upon that state's population through a process known as apportionment.

Inaugurate – To officially swear into the office that was won at election.

Inauguration – The day an elected official is sworn into office.

Incumbent – The incumbent is the current holder of an office or position who is running for re-election in that position.

Independent – A citizen or politician who does not affiliate with any political party.

Independent voter – A citizen who does not identify with either the Democratic or Republican parties and votes for candidates based on issues rather than political ideologies.

Judicial – Of or pertaining to a court or judge.

Law – A set of rules and regulations that govern the behavior of citizens within a state or country.

Legislative body – This consists of the elected members of the House of Representatives and the Senate who create and enact laws.

Legislature – A group of elected representatives who convene for the purpose of creating and enacting laws.

Liberal – A citizen who leans toward the Democratic Party and the part of the party platform that suggests the government should support social and political change.

Legislative Council – A group of people who convene for the purpose of creating rules and regulations as they relate to the governance of a particular area, situation, or circumstance.

Libertarian – A supporter of minimal state intervention in the lives of citizens and advocates for more free choice for citizens.

Lieutenant governor – The second highest position in state government following the governor.

Lobby – The process of persuading government officials to vote on specific issues in a manner that is beneficial to the lobbyist's interests.

Local government – A type of government that governs a smaller geographic location. Some examples of local government are city, village, or township governments with mayoral, manager, or commissioner leadership respectively.

Majority rule – In an election, the candidate who receives more than half of the votes, or more than 51%, from the electorate wins the election. In Congress, majority rule applies to bills and decisions that require a vote.

Mayor – An elected official of the highest office in a city. The mayor establishes the budget, manages the city's resources, and oversees the police, fire, and public works departments.

Member – A member of a legislative body like Congress.

Moderate – An individual who prescribes to the philosophies and policies that would be considered "in the middle" on political issues. They do not prescribe to extreme left or right policies.

Non-Partisan – Non-partisan refers to issues, proposals or elections that do not identify with any political party. For example, proposals to continue funding for public libraries or zoos are non-partisan. The city clerk's office is also non-partisan as they are responsible for administering elections.

Office – A public and political position that is held by an elected official.

Official – An elected individual who formally occupies a public position.

Partisan – A citizen who strongly agrees with and supports a particular political party.

Partisanship – A bias or favor toward a particular political party.

Party – A group of citizens who unite under common political philosophies and policies.

Plurality – In an election, the candidate with the highest percentage of votes from the electorate wins the election.

Political – Of or pertaining to politics.

Political affiliation – Alignment and agreement with a political party or group.

Political issue – Policy ideas or areas of support for which a candidate campaigns during an election period. Examples of such issues can include racism and racial inequality, healthcare and human rights.

Political office – A position within a government.

Politician – A person who actively holds or seeks an elected position within a government office with the goal to propose, oppose, or create laws that govern society.

Poll – The process of recording votes.

Poll worker – A citizen hired by a governmental authority that conducts elections who perform tasks which enable votes to be cast and elections to take place.

Poll watcher – Someone from a political party who is engaged to monitor the actions taking place at voting locations.

Polling place/station – The physical location identified as a voter's place to cast a vote. The locations are assigned to voter's according to ward or precinct based upon residential zip code.

Pollster – A surveyor; someone who collects data and offers predictions of outcomes.

Popular vote – The vote of the people. The candidate who gained the most votes on election day by the people as opposed to electoral votes, received the popular vote.

Precinct – An identified geographic jurisdiction that contains a particular number of eligible voters.

Precinct delegate – An individual elected from a precinct who provides certain political services to candidates running for office, such as connectivity to party resources and attending party conventions.

President – Highest office of the Executive Branch of government in the United States.

Primary election – An election in which the candidates for an office are initially determined. Usually, this is when the candidates under the same party are narrowed down.

Progressive – A person who identifies with a particular political philosophy that has been termed progressive. Progressives think that the resources of the government should be used to resolve the problems of the people.

Proposal – This is a suggested policy that shows up on the ballot to vote on. Some examples of proposals are to legalize marijuana or to allocate tax revenue.

Registered mail – Mail that is registered and recorded at the post office.

Republic – A representative form of government. Citizens vote to send candidates to represent them in the government.

Republican – An individual who prescribes to the philosophies and policies of the Republican Party.

Resident – An individual who resides within a certain jurisdiction.

Secretary of State – An office with state or federal governments with various responsibilities over elections, registration of vehicles/identification, and election supervision. On the federal level the Secretary of State heads the State Department which is an office of the president's cabinet.

Senate – There are 100 senators that make up this part of Congress. Two people are elected from each state to represent their state at the federal level.

Speaker of the House – A representative elected from one of the 50 states who rises to the top position in the House of Representatives. Their role is to conduct the business of the House in the United States Congress.

State government – Each state has its own constitution which establishes how the state will operate. The governor is the elected leader of the state.

Supreme Court – The highest judicial court in the United States. There are nine justices that make up the court.

Term – A length of time to serve in a political office.

Veto – A power that enables the executive to strike down a law passed by legislators. Mayors, governors and presidents hold this power.

Vice president – Second in command of the United States; operates under the supervision of the President of the United States as a part of the Executive Branch of government.

Vote – The act of casting a ballot to make a decision about candidates and/or proposals following an election campaign on election day. The voter can place his or her vote in person or by mail as an absentee.

Voter – Citizens and residents of the United States that are registered to cast their votes in an election.

Voting booth – This is a small and secure area for a voter to cast their ballot for an election. It is located at a physically assigned polling place according to the voter's residence and is identified as a precinct.

Write-in candidate – A candidate for public office whose name does not appear on a ballot, due to not having secured the nomination of a political party. In this case, the voter will write in the name of the candidate on the ballot and cast their vote for that candidate.

SOURCES

Election Resources

National Conference of State Legislatures - [NCSL.org](https://www.ncsl.org), [Vote.org](https://www.vote.org), [Vote.gov](https://www.vote.gov), ballotpedia.org, Center for U.S. Voters Abroad - usvotersabroad.org, Federal Voting Assistance Program - fvap.gov/citizen-voter

Editorial Resources

'Executive Order 14168 — "Defending Women From Gender Ideology Extremism and Restoring Biological Truth to the Federal Government" (signed January 20, 2025) <https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2025-01-30/pdf/2025-02090.pdf>

"Sex Marker in Passports" — U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Consular Affairs <https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/passports/passport-help/sex-marker.html>

Kansas SB 244 (2025–2026 session) — H. Sub for SB 244 https://www.kslegislature.gov/documents/view-leg?apn=b2025_26%2Fyear%2Fready_for_publication%2Fsb_244%2Fsb244_enrolled.pdf

Florida Statutes § 322.08 — "Application for license; requirements for license and identification card forms" https://www.leg.state.fl.us/Statutes/index.cfm?AppMode=Display_Statute&URL=0300-0399%2F0322%2FSections%2F0322.08.html

Tennessee SB 1440 / HB 239 (2023) — "AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 1, Chapter 3 and Title 49, Chapter 2, Part 8, relative to statutory definitions" (effective July 1, 2023; codified at Tenn. Code Ann. § 1-3-105(c)) <https://capitol.tn.gov/Bills/113/Bill/HB0239.pdf>

Indiana Amended rule: 140 IAC 7-1.1-3 — "License, permit, and identification card documentation requirements" (LSA Document #25-321, effective February 12, 2026) <https://iar.iga.in.gov/register/20251015-IR-140250321SNA>

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All information about voting registration, voting options and deadlines are collected from government and trusted non-profit organization sources including National Conference of State Legislatures (NCSL.org), [vote.org](https://www.vote.org), ballotpedia.org, and the respective state election office and secretary of state websites for each state. All information is subject to change and you should check your election office for the latest updates. This information guide is provided as a reference only. State candidate guides are for reference only and may contain candidates who are withdrawn or disqualified from their respective races. State candidate guides are NOT official ballots. List of candidates in each state were checked based on the reported information found on ballotpedia.org as of September 10th, 2026. Double check with your election office for the current and most up to date list of candidates running in your state and district. (D) = Democrat, (R) = Republican, (I) = Independent, (G) = Green Party, (L) = Libertarian, (3P) = Third Party, (U) = Unspecified



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